Clare *Whitlock*



Endcliffe Vale School, 2025

NOW
Head of Year 9, Teacher of History

LOOKING FOR
Curriculum leadership

CONTACT
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01 Profile

I have taught history in Sheffield for fourteen years, and for the last four I have looked after Year 9 at Endcliffe Vale School: 212 students, nine tutors and one long corridor. What I enjoy most is planning: deciding what a thirteen-year-old should still remember at twenty, then building the lessons backwards from there.

I am now looking for a curriculum leadership role where that planning is the whole job: setting out what a department teaches across five years, and helping the teachers who teach it.

02 Experience

2021 to present

Head of Year 9 Endcliffe Vale School, Sheffield

I lead the pastoral team for a year group of 212 students and nine form tutors, and still teach history to Years 9 to 11.

- Year 9 attendance up from 91.8% to 94.6% in two years with a tutor-led morning check-in.
- Rebuilt the options evening so every student leaves with a named adult for GCSE questions.
- On the group that rewrote the Key Stage 3 humanities curriculum for 2024.

2017 to 2021

Second in History Endcliffe Vale School, Sheffield

Planned the Key Stage 3 history curriculum with the head of department and mentored new teachers.

- Wrote Sheffield at Work, a Year 8 unit now taught in 11 city schools.
- Mentored six trainee and early-career teachers.
- Year 11 grade 4+ results rose from 58% to 71%.

2012 to 2017

Teacher of History Loxley Bank Academy, Sheffield

Taught history and citizenship across Key Stages 3 and 4, starting in my training year.

- Led the Year 10 Somme and Ypres trip for four springs, 40 students each time.
- Started the club that became the school's first A level history group.

2010 to 2011

Teaching Assistant, Key Stage 2 Norton Grange Primary School, Sheffield

Ran small reading groups in Years 5 and 6 for a year before training to teach.

03 Education

PGCE, Secondary History
Northern Institute of Education, 2012
Placements at Loxley Bank Academy and an 11 to 18 school in Rotherham.

BA (Hons) History
Pennine University, 2010
Dissertation on women's work in the Sheffield cutlery trades, 1890 to 1914.

04 Training

Leading Teaching, middle leaders
Northern Institute of Education, 2023

Youth Mental Health First Aider
Northern Youth Wellbeing Trust, 2022

Educational Visits Leader
Sheffield Learning Partnership, 2014

05 Selected work

Sheffield at Work
Year 8 unit, 2019
Six local-history lessons on how the city made a living, each ending with something students make. Now taught in 11 Sheffield schools.

The battlefields trip
Year 10 trip, since 2013
Four days on the Somme and at Ypres for 40 students, each of whom first finds a soldier from their own street in the city archive.

The morning check-in
Pastoral, 2022
Ten minutes in which every tutor speaks to every student by name. Year 9 attendance rose from 91.8% to 94.6% in two years.

06 Skills

Curriculum design / KS3 and KS4 history / Pastoral leadership / Safeguarding / Assessment and moderation / Mentoring / Educational visits / Parents and carers

07 References

She plans backwards from what a thirteen-year-old will actually remember, which is rarer than it should be. Sheffield at Work is the best unit our department teaches, and Clare wrote it around a full timetable. Eleven schools now use it.

Tom Adeyemi, Head of History, Endcliffe Vale School

Clare knows every one of her 212 Year 9s by name and, more usefully, by what each of them needs. When she rebuilt our morning check-in, attendance moved within a term and stayed moved. She is ready to lead a curriculum, and I would say so to anyone.

Rachel Ostrowski, Deputy Headteacher, Endcliffe Vale School

Clare mentored me through my first two years. She watched my worst lessons without flinching and gave me one thing to change each week, never five. I still plan the way she taught me.

Priya Natarajan, Teacher of History, Endcliffe Vale School

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AVAILABLE
From September 2027

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REFERENCES
In full on request